

H I R A A L

ERPNext | DATA ARCHIVER

ERPNext Data Archiver

Product Documentation

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SCOPE

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SECTION 01

The One-Page Summary

ERPNext Data Archiver moves completed fiscal-year transactional data out of live tables into same-database shadow tables so the active site stays fast, while balances and history remain correct when you need them.

Table 1 - What changes for day-to-day ERPNext work

Layer	Today without archive	After this module
Live tables	All years compete for indexes and cache	Current FY + open docs only; history moved out
Balances	Reports scan full GL / SLE history	Opening-state synthetics keep current FY correct
History	Always online, always slow	On-demand via date routing or session Retrieve
Safety	Manual cleanup is risky	Preflight checks, backup confirmation, verified move, reconciliation before completion

The promise

Same ERPNext subscription. Same MariaDB. No separate archive server required. After archive, day-to-day work behaves like a site that started in the current fiscal year. Historical ranges are served only when explicitly requested.

How It Works

HOT PATH VS HISTORY

Active (current-period) queries read only live tables plus compact opening-state snapshots. They never scan archive transaction tables. Archive tables are joined only for archive-only or cross-year date ranges, or when a user retrieves years.

Table 2 - Query routing modes

Mode	When	Data sources
Active	Range on/after cutoff	Live + opening state (no archive UNION)
Archive	Range entirely before cutoff	Matching archive partitions
Combined	Range spans cutoff	Live + scoped archive; openings not double-counted
Session retrieve	User opt-in on Desk	Selected archived years in this session

Standard ERPNext Desk after login:

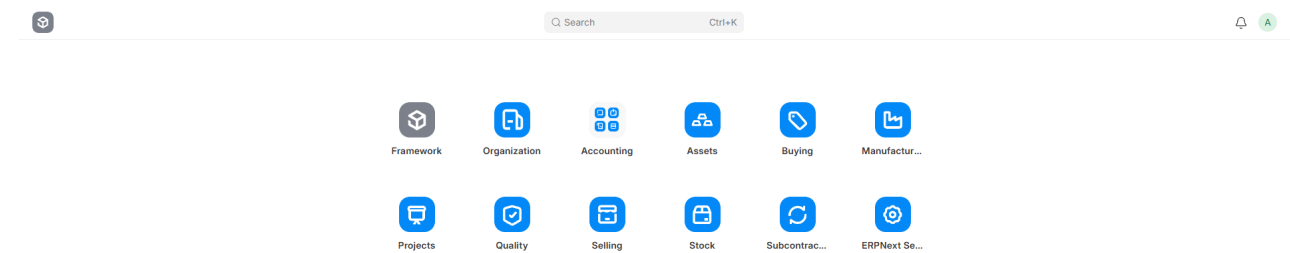


Figure 1 - Desk home

SECTION 03

Install and Roles

```
bench get-app /path/to/erpnext_data_archiver
bench --site your.site install-app erpnext_data_archiver
bench --site your.site migrate
bench build --app erpnext_data_archiver
bench --site your.site clear-cache
```

Table 3 - Permission matrix

Role	Can do
System Manager	Full configure, archive, restore, uninstall policy
Archive Manager	Configure, preview, archive, restore, retrieve
Accounts / Stock Manager	Browse retrieve / session years (no archive run)

Uninstall protection

The app cannot be uninstalled while archived fiscal years or archive tables still hold data. Restore or export history first, then uninstall.

SECTION 04

Configure Archive Settings

Open Archive Settings from Desk search. Enable the module, record backup evidence, and choose Archive Through Fiscal Year (preferred) so the cutoff is set automatically.

The screenshot shows the 'Archive Settings' form in ERPNext. The form is titled 'Archive Settings' and has a 'Save' button in the top right. It contains several sections:

- Enabled:** A checkbox that is checked. Below it, a description: 'Master switch. When disabled no archiving runs.'
- Auto Archive Daily:** An unchecked checkbox. Below it, a description: 'Automatically archive data older than the current fiscal year once per day (background job).'
- Require Backup Reference:** A checked checkbox. Below it, a description: 'Block archive until last_backup_id and last_backup_checksum are set (PRE-006).'
- Batch Size:** A text input field with the value '500'. Below it, a description: 'Rows copied per batch. Lower values keep locks shorter on busy sites.'
- Archive Through Fiscal Year:** A text input field with the value '2025'. Below it, a description: 'Pick the last closed fiscal year to move out of live tables (e.g. 2025). Everything through the end of that year is archived; the current year stays live. This sets the cutoff date automatically.'
- Archive Cutoff Date:** A text input field with the value '01-01-2026'. Below it, a description: 'Advanced: only rows before this date are archived. Usually filled from Archive Through Fiscal Year. Leave empty to auto-use the start of the current fiscal year.'
- Backup Evidence:** A section containing three fields:
 - Last Backup ID:** A text input field with the value 'demo-backup-2026-08-16'. Below it, a description: 'Identifier of the verified database/files backup taken before archive.'
 - Last Backup Checksum:** A text input field with the value 'sha256:demo-verified-restore'. Below it, a description: 'Checksum or restore-test status of that backup.'
 - Confirmation Phrase:** A text input field with the value 'ARCHIVE'. Below it, a description: 'User must type this phrase to confirm archive (maker control).'

Figure 2 - Archive Settings

Table 4 - Settings fields

Field	Production	Notes
Enabled	Yes	Master switch
Require Backup Reference	Yes	Blocks run until backup ID + checksum set
Last Backup ID / Checksum	Yes	Evidence of verified backup
Confirmation Phrase	Yes	Default ARCHIVE
Archive Through Fiscal Year	Recommended	Sets cutoff to day after year ends
Archive Cutoff Date	Auto	Rows before this date are eligible
Batch Size	Tune	Lower on busy sites
DocType Rules	Review	Seeded GL, SLE, invoices, orders, stock...

Archive vs Retrieve

You archive through a fiscal year (or cutoff date). You do not pick years on the Retrieve page to archive - that list is only for reading already-archived years.

SECTION 05

Run an Archive

FROM ARCHIVE SETTINGS

1 Record backup evidence

Set Last Backup ID and Checksum after a verified backup.

V

2 Pick the year

Set Archive Through Fiscal Year (for example 2025).

V

3 Preview

Preview Archive must show Preflight OK and row estimates.

V

4 Confirm and run

Run Archive Now - type the confirmation phrase.

V

5 Watch the run

Open Archive Run and wait until status is Completed.

A successful preview looks like this:

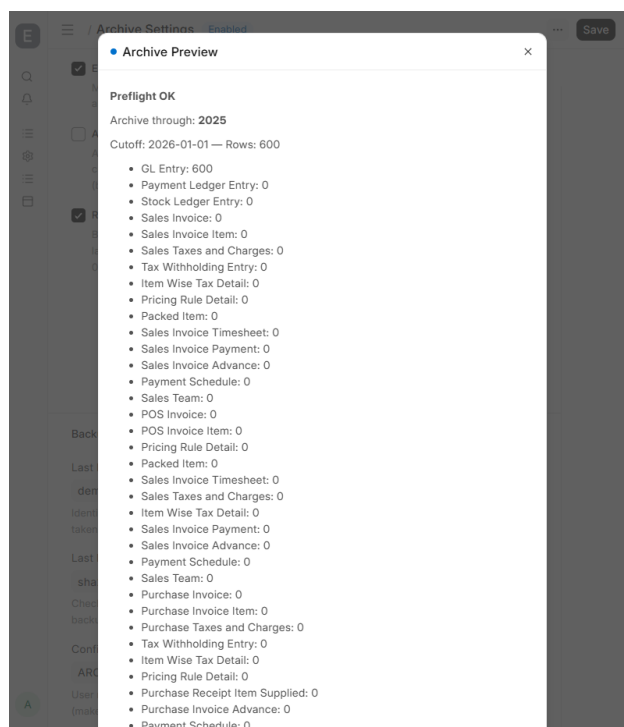


Figure 3 - Archive Preview (Preflight OK)

When the job finishes, Archive Run shows Completed with evidence:

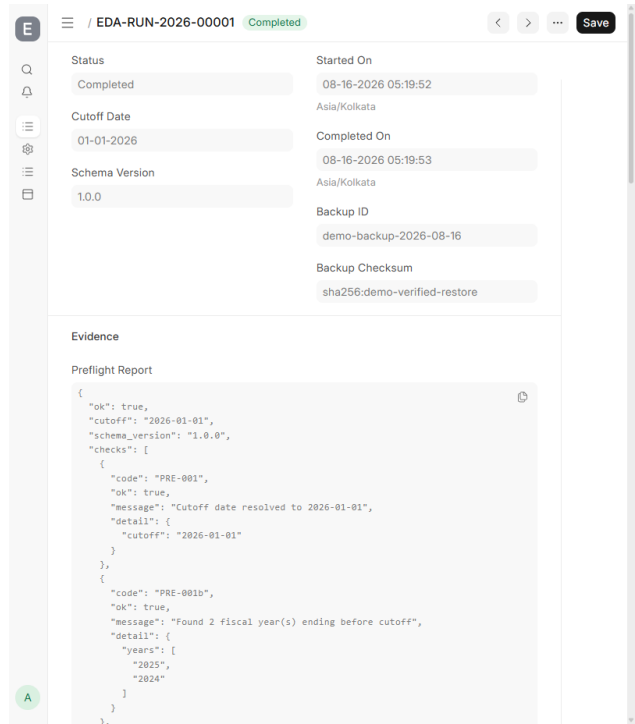


Figure 4 - Completed Archive Run

Table 5 - Common preflight blockers

Code	Meaning	Action
PRE-002	Drafts before cutoff	Clear or submit drafts
PRE-003	Pending reposts	Finish or cancel repost jobs
PRE-004	Another archive already running	Wait for it to finish, or mark a stuck run Failed
PRE-006	Backup missing	Set Last Backup ID and Checksum

Table 6 - What success looks like

Metric	Before archive	After archive
Historical GL (before cutoff)	Present in live tables	Moved to archive tables
Current-year balances	Built from full history	Preserved via opening entries
Archive Run status	-	Completed

SECTION 06

Retrieve and Restore

SESSION RETRIEVE (READ ONLY)

Path: Retrieve Archived Data. Tick already-archived years, Apply to this session, then Use live data only to return to the hot path. Retrieval does not move data.

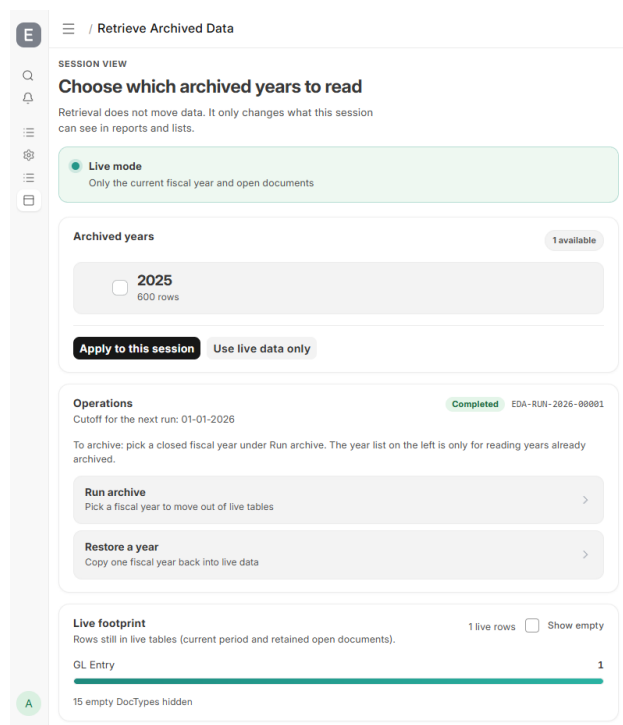


Figure 5 - Retrieve Archived Data (Live mode)

After applying year 2025:

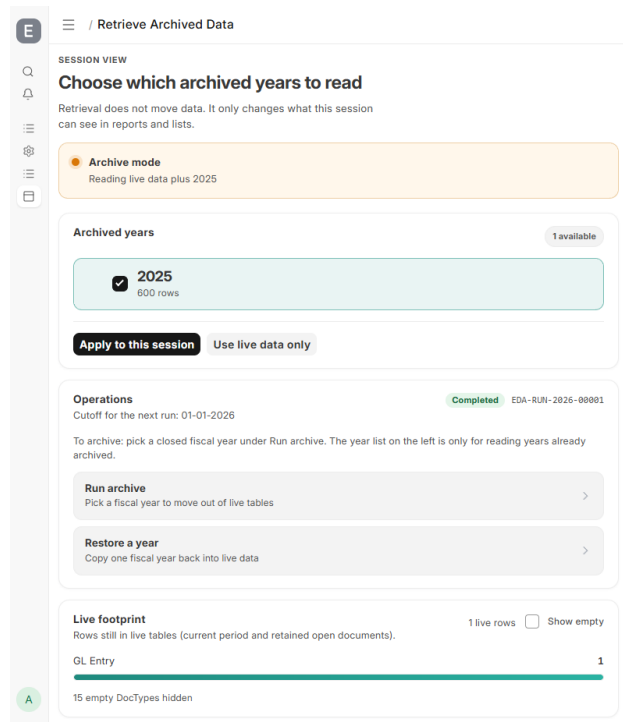


Figure 6 - Session Archive mode - reading live data plus 2025

RESTORE A FISCAL YEAR

Managers only. Collision dry-run first; resolve or force only after review. After success, openings are rebuilt for the live cutoff.

SECTION 07

Operations and Support

DAY-TO-DAY CHECKLIST

- Verified DB (+ files) backup; ID and checksum in Archive Settings
- Fiscal Year masters exist for years you will archive
- Pending reposts / blocking drafts cleared
- Preview = Preflight OK
- Archive Run = Completed with evidence JSON
- Current FY reports look correct
- Optional: retrieve one archived year, then return to live-only

Table 7 - Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Archive blocked (PRE-004)	Wait for the current run, or mark a stuck Archive Run as Failed
No years on Retrieve page	Complete at least one successful archive first
Cannot uninstall the app	Restore or export archived years, then uninstall
Archive Run Failed	Open the run, fix the reported cause, then run again